Pradeep Yellapu

2406107815 | pyellapu@umd.edu | LinkedIn | Github | Portfolio

SUMMARY

Product Designer & UX Researcher with 3+ years shipping user-centered digital products across enterprise SaaS, AI platforms, and consumer applications. ***Selected by the University of Maryland*** to deploy AI-powered data products to East African government ministries, solutions spanning 9 countries, ***32% bounce rate reduction***, and 85x delivery acceleration.

Key outcomes: 40% reduction in user friction, ***167% engagement lift***, and ***750+ enterprise users*** supported annually; strong collaborator who bridges design, research, and engineering to ship products that drive real business value.

WORK EXPERIENCE

NASA Harvest | University of Maryland **Nov 2025 - Present**
Product Designer & Researcher *College Park, MD*

- **Led end-to-end product design** for **AGRA AI AutoPilot** by conducting stakeholder interviews with government analysts & engineers, mapped mental models via **affinity mapping**, and translated user research findings into **progressive disclosure navigation** for a 9-country satellite data product; validated designs through **think-aloud testing** and iterated on information hierarchy to improve data comprehension for non-technical users across 6 East African ministries.
- **Architected 2 Figma design systems from 0-to-1** for a NASA-affiliated research lab, defined design tokens (color, type scale, spacing), built **atomic component libraries** with contribution guidelines, and shipped in HTML/CSS across 2 live products.
- Selected by the University of Maryland as **lead designer for a government AI onboarding program** in Nairobi, **designed a 5-day curriculum** (learner journeys, task flows, decision frameworks) and facilitated delivery to 30+ senior agricultural officials across 6 East African nations, translating complex AI satellite monitoring tools into accessible, policy-level experiences.
- **Applied content design** to distill multi-signal satellite data (SMAP, NDVI, ESI) into 2 annotated 4-page executive decision frameworks, **presented at an international conference** and adopted by East African food security policymakers.

MarketCrunch AI **Jun 2025 - Sep 2025**
Product Design & UX Research Intern *San Francisco, CA (Remote)*

- **Led a comprehensive UX audit** across 20+ fintech screens (Robinhood, Yahoo Finance, TradingView) using Nielsen's 10 usability principles and **conducted semi-structured interviews** with institutional traders to surface mental models and trust factors in AI-generated recommendations, synthesized into design guidelines that reduced reporting errors by 15%.
- Designed and **validated high-fidelity prototypes** through moderated usability testing with 12 enterprise users, launching 2 features that **increased elite plan sales by 40**% along with establishing a scalable design system with component libraries, directly reducing design-to-development hand-off time.
- Improved onboarding flow, dashboard Information Architecture (IA), and data visualization patterns achieving a **167% increase in new user attempts**; applied **Material UI (MUI) design standards** and ensured WCAG 2.1 AA compliance across the product.

Hack4Impact@UMD **Nov 2024 - May 2025**
UX Designer *College Park, MD*

- **Conducted generative user research** with nonprofit stakeholders through semi-structured interviews and contextual inquiry, synthesized findings via **affinity mapping in Miro** to identify 3 key design opportunities that directly guided the product roadmap.
- **Conducted workflow analysis and stakeholder interviews**, leveraging Power BI and Figma to translate requirements into user-centered **automated BI dashboards** that delivered clearer operational insights for IT teams.
- **Presented design recommendations** in a stakeholder workshop using quantitative usability testing metrics, demonstrating a **20% increase in task-completion speed.**

Computacenter **Jan 2023 - Jul 2024**
Technical UX Analyst *Bengaluru, IN*

- **Designed automated diagnostic dashboards** using ScienceLogic, PowerShell, and Selenium, applied **information design principles** to reduce MTTR by 40% for IT support teams.
- **Conducted workflow analysis and stakeholder interviews**, leveraging Power BI and Figma to translate requirements into user-centered **automated BI dashboards** that delivered clearer operational insights for IT teams.

My Equation **May 2022 - Jun 2023**
Market Research Analyst, UI/UX Designer *Ahmedabad, IN*

- **Led mixed-methods UX research** using **Double Diamond methodology**, conducted user interviews and competitive analysis that drove **35% revenue growth** through strategic rebranding.

PROJECTS

Transurban Express Lanes UX Research **Sep 2024 - Dec 2024**
University of Maryland *College Park, MD*

- Conducted mixed-methods UX research using surveys (n=127), semi-structured interviews (n=8), and usability testing to evaluate express lane user experience and identify pain points in toll payment systems.
- Applied thematic analysis and affinity mapping to synthesize research findings, identifying critical usability issues in wayfinding, toll transparency, and account management that impacted user trust and adoption.
- Developed data-driven design recommendations for improved signage, real-time pricing displays, and mobile app enhancements based on SUS scores and qualitative feedback analysis.

INFO Faculty Dashboard UX Research **Jan 2025 - May 2025**
University of Maryland *College Park, MD*

- Conducted contextual interviews with UMD iNFO faculty to understand workload tracking pain points; performed affinity mapping to identify recurring themes.
- Synthesized research insights into journey maps and task flows, proposing streamlined dashboard design improving task ownership clarity.

SKILLS

- **Design**: Human-Centric Design (HCD), Interaction Design, Visual Design, Data Analysis, Prototyping, Information Architecture, Design Systems, Accessibility (WCAG 2.1 & 2.2 AA), Section 508, Usability Testing
- **Research**: Journey Mapping, Card Sorting, In-Depth Interviews, Ethnographic Research, Competitive Analysis, Qualitative & Quantitative Research, Task Analysis, Heuristic Evaluation, Contextual Inquiry, Thematic Analysis, Surveys, A/B Testing, Usability Testing
- **Tools**: Figma, Adobe XD, Photoshop, Illustrator, After Effects, Framer, Webflow, Miro, Notion, Power BI, MUI, QGIS, Tableau, Generative-AI Tools, Claude Code
- **Technical**: HTML/CSS, JavaScript, Python, SQL, QGIS, Git/GitHub, React, Docker

EDUCATION

University of Maryland **Aug 2024 - May 2026**
Master of Science, Data Science, Minor in User Experience (UX) Research Methods *College Park, MD, USA*

- **GPA:** 3.85

SRM Institute of Science & Technology **Jun 2019 - May 2023**
Bachelor of Technology, Computer Science & Business Systems *Tech Park, India*

- **GPA:** 3.70

ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Featured on Wall of Portfolios -** selected among top 30% of submitted portfolios, Apr 2026
- **Co-authored 2 policy briefs** presented at the AGRA Regional Food Balance Sheet International Conference, Nairobi, Kenya - geospatial data visualizations adopted by government ministries across 6 East African nations
- **Guest Speaker & Workshop Facilitator** - HFES Student Chapter, George Mason University; led Figma Prototyping Crash Course for human factors grad students
- **Published in Medium's Bootcamp publication** - "Why UX Designers Matter More Than Ever in the Age of AI", Mar 2025
- **Creative Award of the Year** - Computacenter, 2024
- **Microsoft MLSA –** Vinci Di UI Design Challenge, **Winner – 2019**

CERTIFICATIONS

DHS Certified Trusted Tester for Web Accessibility - WCAG evaluation (Section 508) **March 2026**
CITI Program Certification - Social & Behavioral Research: ID: 67782636 **Feb. 2025**
Foundations of User Experience (UX) Design by Google: ID: 9HTB2SYBKWX9 **March 2022**